

Food Preparation & Safety Policy

Effective Date: June 1, 2026 | Version 1.0

Purpose

This policy establishes safe food handling and preparation practices for all meal preparation services provided by Good Company. The goal is to protect client health by preventing foodborne illness and accommodating dietary restrictions and allergies.

Scope of Service

Good Company provides light meal preparation, including simple cooking, reheating, sandwich making, and meal assembly. Good Company does not provide:

- Therapeutic or medically prescribed diets without family/physician guidance
- Tube feeding or specialized nutritional support
- Food shopping for clients without an approved grocery list
- Preparation of raw or undercooked meats, fish, or shellfish
- Canning, fermenting, or other preservation methods

Personal Hygiene

Before preparing any food, staff must:

- Wash hands thoroughly with soap and warm water
- Wash hands again after handling raw meat, touching face/hair, sneezing, or using the restroom
- Wear clean clothing free of strong odors
- Tie back long hair
- Avoid working if experiencing symptoms of illness (fever, vomiting, diarrhea, infectious skin conditions)
- Cover any open cuts or wounds with a clean bandage and disposable gloves

Kitchen Cleanliness

- Clean and sanitize all work surfaces before and after food preparation
- Use separate cutting boards or thoroughly wash between raw meat and ready-to-eat foods
- Wash all fresh produce before use
- Use clean utensils, dishes, and cookware
- Wash dishes promptly after meals
- Dispose of food waste appropriately

- Clean up spills immediately

Expiration Date Checks

Before using any food item, staff must:

- Check expiration or "use by" dates
- Inspect for signs of spoilage (off odors, mold, discoloration, slimy texture)
- Discard any food past its expiration date or showing signs of spoilage
- Inform the client or family if frequently expired items are found in the home, so groceries can be replenished

Allergies and Dietary Restrictions

Each client's allergies and dietary restrictions are documented during intake and reviewed before every meal preparation. Common considerations include:

- Food allergies (nuts, shellfish, dairy, eggs, soy, wheat, etc.)
- Medical dietary restrictions (low sodium, low sugar, diabetic-friendly, renal diet)
- Religious or cultural dietary requirements
- Texture modifications (soft, pureed) per family or physician instruction
- Swallowing precautions or thickened liquids as directed

Cross-Contamination Prevention

- Store raw meats on the bottom shelf of the refrigerator to prevent drips onto other foods
- Use separate cutting boards for raw meat and produce, or thoroughly wash between uses
- Never use the same utensil for raw meat and cooked food without washing
- Wash hands between handling different food groups

Documentation

Meal preparation activities are noted in the daily visit report, including:

- Meals prepared
- Whether the client ate the meal
- Any concerns noted (appetite changes, swallowing difficulty, etc.)
- Allergies or restrictions observed

Policy Review

This policy is reviewed annually. All staff members must read and acknowledge this policy before providing meal preparation services.

Policy reviewed and approved by:

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Natalie Perras', written over a horizontal line.

Natalie Perras, Owner

Date: 6/9/2026